

CLASS MATERIAL

WEEK 2

CEL2103 WRITING ACADEMIC TEXT
SEMESTER 2, 2024-2025

Introduction to Comparison and Contrast Essay

- Pre-writing
 - Generating topic
 - Identifying points of comparison
- Language:
 - Writing style of an academic essay

Pre-writing: Generating a Topic for Compare and Contrast Essay

Topics for compare and contrast essays can involve variety of themes. You can compare ideas, events, people, different times in history, objects and many more.

Activity 1

What are the features of a good topic for a compare and contrast essay?

- a. _____
- b. _____
- c. _____

Activity 2

Decide whether the subjects for the topics below can be compared by writing Yes or No. If No, rewrite the topics by including subjects that can be compared.

No	Topic	Yes/ No	New Topic
1	Similarities and differences of two English tests: MUET and TOEFL		
2	A comparison of government systems between Malaysia and Thailand		
3	Leonardo da Vinci vs Titanic: A comparison		
4	Comparing the environment of schools and colleges		
5	Comparing the effects of World War I and World War II		
6	Comparing and contrasting the causes of earthquakes and noise pollution		
7	Differences and similarities of lifestyle in Spain and New York		
8	A comparison of online learning and face-to-face learning		

Activity 3

Write the suitable subjects based on the given theme and topic. The subjects must belong to the same category and they can be compared.

1. Theme : Cultures
Topic : Comparing and contrasting the working culture of two countries
Subjects :

2. Theme : Events
Topic : Similarities and differences between two international sporting events
Subjects :

3. Theme : Travel destinations
Topic : A comparison of two different popular travel destinations
Subjects :

Activity 4

Write a possible topic and subjects of a compare and contrast essay based on the given theme.

Theme	Topic	Subjects
Lifestyle		1. 2.
Prominent figures		1. 2.
Travel destinations		1. 2.
Products		1. 2.

Pre-writing: Identifying Points of Comparison

Activity 5

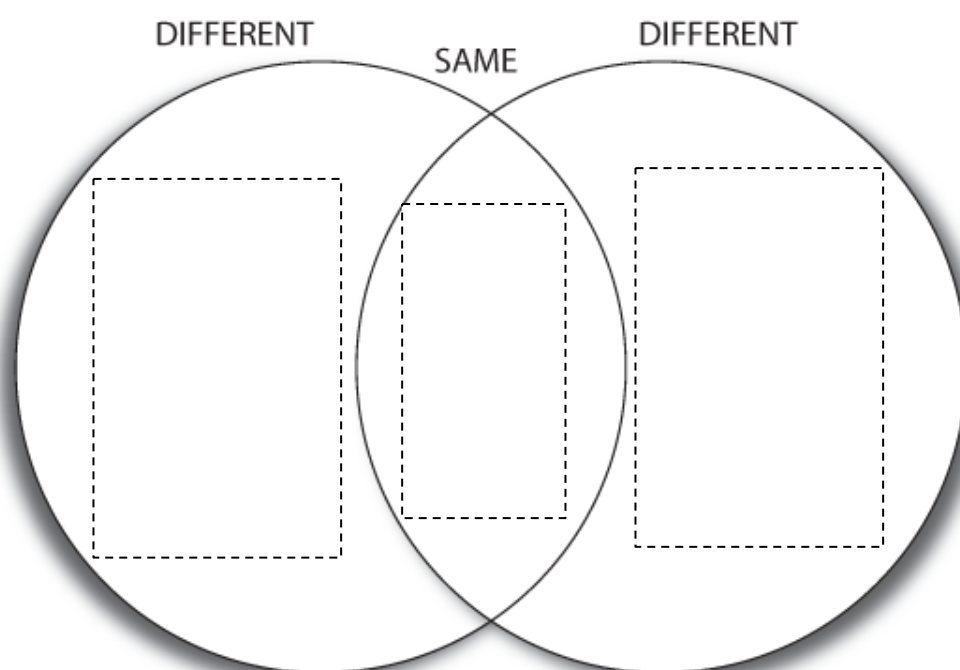
What are points of comparison in a compare and contrast essay?

Activity 6

Choose a topic from Activity 2 and complete the Venn Diagram below by listing possible points that are similar and different.

Topic: _____

Venn Diagram



Activity 7

Based on the Venn Diagram in Activity 6, identify the points of comparison for your topic. Complete the compare and contrast table below.

Topic: _____			
Point of Comparison		Subject A: _____	Subject B: _____
Similarity	_____	Supporting points: a. b.	Supporting points: a. b.
	_____	Supporting points: a. b.	Supporting points: a. b.

Language: Writing Style of an Academic Essay

Activity 8

Rewrite the sentences below in an academic style of writing.

1. Regrettably these days lots of people don't have jobs.

2. You can't always trust the numbers in the report.

3. Sadly, the bad inflation led to poverty, social unrest and so on.

4. Researchers have been looking into the problem for 15 years.

5. This essay will discuss how much this option will cost.
